

48V Electrical Architecture

Document role

- This file owns the final 48V electrical architecture for the active build baseline.
- Use it for house-bank structure, alternator-path direction, shutdown logic, and manual control-path intent.
- Keep full conductor schedules, fuse matrices, and layout-level implementation detail in docs/implementation/ .
- Keep unresolved vendor gates, risk state, and follow-up closure items in docs/core/TRACKING.md .
- Keep broad project sequencing and day-to-day execution framing in docs/core/PROJECT.md or the active plan docs.

As-of date: 2026-07-19

Purpose: hold the finalized, concise 48V house and alternator architecture in one place so wiring, protection, shutdown behavior, and BOM references are easy to understand without re-reading the historical trade studies.

Related docs:

- [Electrical topology diagram](#)
- [Electrical fuse schedule](#)
- [Mechman / WS500 / APM-48 install guide](#)
- [Systems](#)
- [Tracking](#)
- [Estimated BOM](#)

Final direction

- House architecture stays 48V core with 3x 51.2V 100Ah batteries in parallel.
- Alternator charging is the dedicated 48V secondary alternator path; obsolete pre-Mechman charger hardware is removed from active planning.
- Protection baseline is Mechman + WS500 + Balmar APM-48 .
- Manual alternator-charge enable/disable is through Ford Upfitter Switch #3 .
- Upfitter #3 is a low-current control signal only. It does not carry alternator output current.
- WS500 white Feature-In is reserved for future fault-interlock work, not required in Phase 1.

Current commissioning state (2026-07-19)

- 48V bus has been live-tested: owner measured 55.5V throughout the system, including at the MultiPlus.
- MultiPlus-II DC/inverter mode has been switched on with inverter light illuminated, slight normal hum, and no reported error lights.
- SmartShunt and Orion-Tr Smart are visible in VictronConnect.
- Cerbo GX access point/remote-console workflow is active; Cerbo power is a small inline fused feed from the 48V system side and MultiPlus communication is via VE.Bus RJ45.
- Shore charging has been tested through the MultiPlus at household-outlet current limits. The first short test proved basic AC-in/charger function; later owner verification redid the settings and confirmed first-battery behavior entered bulk, then quickly transitioned to absorption at/near 100% as planned.
- MultiPlus LiFePO4 charge-profile programming/verification is treated as closed for the current shore-charger setup. Current target is 56.8V absorption/charge, 54.0V float, short absorption dwell, equalization off, conservative LiFePO4 storage behavior, and source-current limit matched to the actual shore circuit. The Dumfume manual's 58.4V +/-0.2V value is documented, but because the same manual also lists 58.4V as charge-limit/over-charge protection voltage, it is not the active routine charger target. DVCC remains disabled unless a documented BMS/GX control path is added.
- The electrical module is now hard-mounted through the finished floor to registered truck-bed hardpoints. The MultiPlus and AC breaker enclosure were removed for the lift and are pending easy front-side remount into embedded pronged T-nuts; final Bench tie-in still supplies the anti-rack/road-restraint path.
- All three batteries' 2/0 AWG branch leads are cut, lugged, heat-shrunk, and landed at the battery-side positive/negative busbars. The three batteries are not yet paralleled: Batteries 2 and 3 remain on the individual-charge/rest/ <=0.1V matching gate.
- Permanent shore inlet/AC-in, full parallel-bank commissioning, 12V branch closeout, AC-out branch/GFCI commissioning, secondary-alternator commissioning, final Cerbo mounting, and board strain-relief/abrasion-control remain separate future gates.

Locked component set

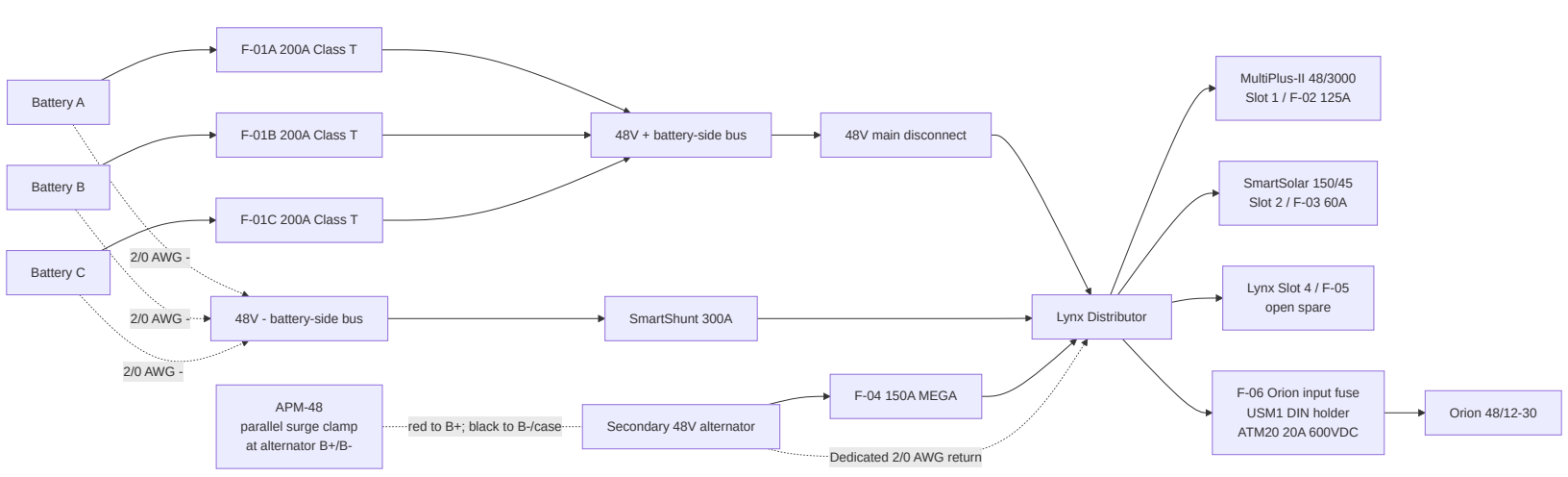
Function	Locked baseline	BOM row(s)
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House batteries	3x Dumfume 51.2V 100Ah LiFePO4	3
Main house disconnect	Victron 275A battery switch	5
Main fused distribution	Victron Lynx Distributor M10	6
Battery branch protection	F-01A/B/C 200A Class T; manual-backed battery limit is 200A max continuous discharge per battery, with terminal/manufacture fuse guidance still not separately specified; owner confirmed 3 holders and 4 slow-blow Class T fuses total	7
Inverter/charger	MultiPlus-II 48/3000/35-50	12
48V to 12V charger	Orion-Tr Smart 48/12-30; fed from Lynx 48V+ bus tap through standalone F-06 (Mersen USM1 DIN holder + ATM20 20A/600VDC fuse, direct 6 AWG); Lynx Slot 4 remains open	20, 11, 230
Monitoring	Cerbo GX + SmartShunt 300A	22, 23
Alternator kit	Mechman 48V secondary alternator kit with WS500	168
Load-dump clamp	Balmar APM-48	169
Alternator branch fuse	F-04 150A MEGA (58V/80V) in Lynx Slot 3	170
WS500 low-current fuse set	F-12 regulator power + F-13 positive voltage sense; current-sense pair is unfused per current manual	171
WS500 Upfitter #3 control kit	F-15 + control wire + holder/terminals	176

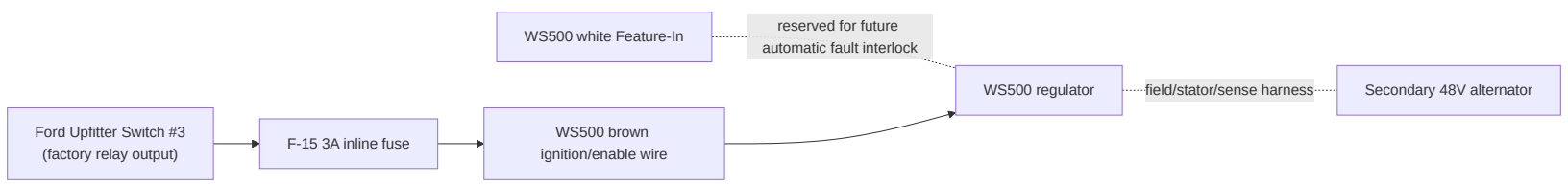
Battery manual limits and charger-programming baseline

- Battery model basis: Dumfume 51.2V 100Ah LiFePO4, 3x in parallel (1S3P ; manual allows up to 1S4P).
- Per-battery charge voltage: 58.4V +/-0.2V ; charge-limit/over-charge protection voltage also listed as 58.4V .
- Per-battery current references: recommended charge 20A ; max continuous charge 100A ; recommended discharge 50A ; max continuous discharge 200A .
- Bank-level reference for current 3x setup: recommended charge 60A ; max continuous charge 300A ; recommended discharge 150A ; max continuous discharge 600A .
- Protection thresholds: over-discharge protection 36.8V , recovery 43.2V ; discharge overcurrent protection 600A ; short-circuit protection 1800A .
- Temperature thresholds: low-temp charge protection approx 41F-50F with recovery at 50F ; high-temp protection listed as 157F / 140F .
- MultiPlus-II charger limit is 35A , so full-output charging is below the bank's 60A recommended-charge reference (~11.7A per battery in 3P). For first household-outlet tests, keep AC input current at 10A , then 12A max on a normal 15A source. Current charger-programming target is 56.8V absorption/charge, 54.0V float, 52.8V storage if shown, 0.5h max absorption, equalization off, and temperature compensation off.

48V power path



Alternator control path



Control logic

- Upfitter #3 ON : WS500 brown wire is energized, regulator is allowed to run, alternator charging can occur.
- Upfitter #3 OFF : WS500 is disabled through the brown wire, regulator field output collapses, and alternator charging stops.
- Use Upfitter #3 as the manual alternator-charge shutdown control.
- Do not use the main 48V disconnect as the first alternator shutdown method while the engine is running and the secondary alternator is charging.

Why Upfitter #3

- It is already a factory-switched, relay-driven 12V control source.
- It keeps the WS500 control in the truck cab without adding a separate aftermarket switch.
- It is suitable for a low-current enable signal, but not for any high-current alternator or battery conductor.
- A local inline fuse is still required because the factory upfitter circuit fuse is much larger than the small-gauge WS500 control wire.

Fusing and wire baseline

ID	Function	Locked value	Wire basis
F-01A/B/C	Battery branch positive protection	200A Class T provisional	2/0 AWG
F-04	Alternator branch into Lynx Slot 3	150A MEGA (58V/80V)	2/0 AWG
F-05	Lynx Slot 4	Open/blank spare fused position; not used for Orion	N/A
F-06	Orion 48v input from Lynx bus tap	Mersen ATM20, 20A/600VDC, in Mersen USM1 DIN holder	Existing 6 AWG direct into pressure-plate terminals; keep source-side unfused tap short
F-12	WS500 regulator power lead	10A baseline (15A if required by alternator case); voltage rating must cover the connected alternator/system positive voltage	harness lead
F-13	WS500 positive voltage-sense lead	3A; fuse/holder voltage class must cover the 48v bank maximum unless proven by WS500 harness	harness lead

		documentation	
CERB0-PWR	Cerbo GX low-current power feed	1A-3A inline fuse/holder rated for the 48V bank maximum; system/load side of main disconnect preferred for bench shutdown	18 AWG red/black duplex acceptable
WS500 current-sense pair	Purple/grey current-sense high/low to shunt/current-sense point	No separate fuse position in current Wakespeed manual; twist pair if extended and route away from noise	harness lead
F-15	Upfitter #3 to WS500 brown ignition wire	3A inline ATO/ATC on 12V control circuit	16 AWG TXL/GXL control wire

Major conductors

- Battery branch and main 48V trunk wiring: 2/0 AWG .
- Parallel battery-current sharing target is similar **total loop resistance** per battery path, not equal positive-only length. The current bench layout may use short/medium/long positive leads balanced by long/medium/short negative leads; do not add unnecessary cable coils solely to make positive leads identical.
- Secondary alternator positive path (ALT B+ -> APM-48 -> F-04 -> Lynx): 2/0 AWG , ~20 ft one-way planning basis.
- Secondary alternator dedicated negative return (ALT B- -> Lynx -): 2/0 AWG , ~20 ft one-way planning basis.
- Orion 48V feeder and MPPT battery leads: 6 AWG ; Orion positive leaves the Lynx bus through standalone F-06 , not Lynx Slot 4.
- Upfitter #3 control lead to WS500 brown wire: 16 AWG TXL/GXL planning basis, ~6 ft one-way assumed until measured.

APM-48 wiring intent

- Mount the APM-48 at the alternator end of the 48V branch, as close to the alternator output/ground points as practical.
- Treat the APM-48 as a parallel surge/load-dump clamp across the alternator, not a series device in the alternator charge-current path.
- Connect APM red to alternator B+ .
- Connect APM black to alternator B- , or to the approved alternator ground/case point if the alternator is not isolated-ground.
- Do **not** place either APM connector under the main battery cable lugs; Balmar's quick-start sheet explicitly prohibits placing APM connectors under the battery cable lugs.

Normal operating sequence

- Main 48V disconnect closed.
- Upfitter #3 switched ON .
- Engine running.
- WS500 enabled and regulating.
- Alternator charges the house bank through APM-48 and F-04 .

Fault and shutdown sequence

If a battery pack trips or an alternator fault is suspected:

- Switch Upfitter #3 OFF to disable the WS500 .
- Wait for alternator charge current to collapse.
- Open the main 48V disconnect only after alternator charging is no longer active, if full house shutdown is required.

Reason:

- The regulator should be shut down first.
- The APM-48 is a protection layer, not the primary shutdown method.

One-battery-trip behavior

- If one battery BMS disconnects but the other two remain online, the 48V bus should stay up.
- The system does not immediately become a full-bank load dump event just because one battery disappears.
- The practical effect is that charge and discharge current redistribute to the remaining batteries.
- The real hazard is a cascade where the second and third battery also disconnect under active alternator charge.

What is still not fully closed

- Final Mechman kit fitment/content confirmation for the exact truck.

- Final WS500 harness polarity confirmation (PH vs NH).
- Official vendor confirmation that the documented Dumfume battery/BMS behavior is acceptable with the WS500 .
- Exact alternator negative/case isolation behavior in the installed Mechman kit.
- Whether future automatic fault-interlock logic should be added on the WS500 Feature-In or through an external relay.

Rule for future edits

- Update this file first for any 48V architecture, alternator-control, or shutdown-strategy change.
- Keep the implementation files for wiring detail and fuse placement, not for high-level architecture decisions.